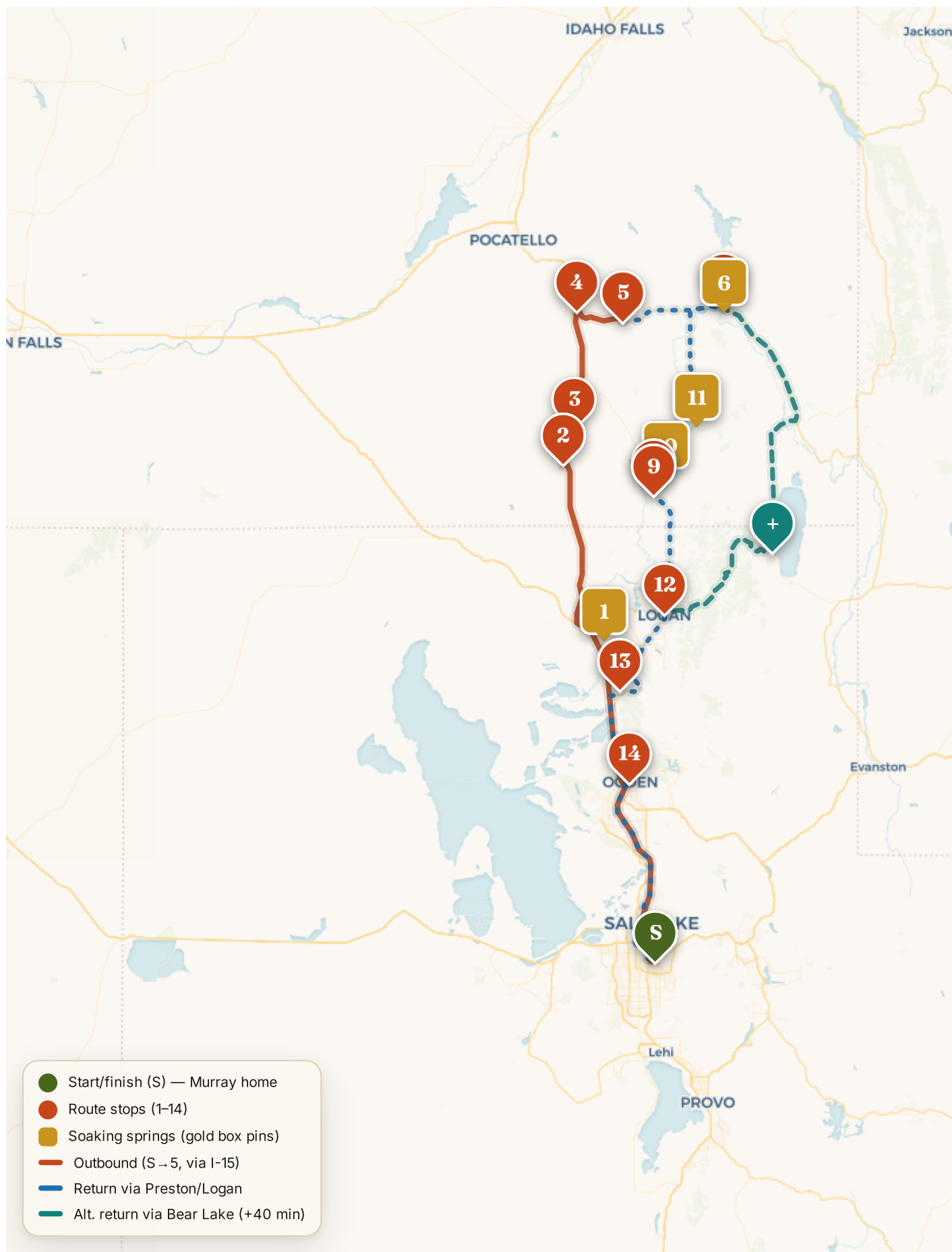




Murray to Lava Hot Springs — and Home Again

Sunday, August 16 · Murray → Crystal Hot Springs → Malad → McCammon → Lava Hot Springs → Soda Springs → Preston → Bear River & Maple Grove Hot Springs → Logan → Brigham City → Ogden → Murray

Two ways home from Soda Springs

Murray → Lava Hot Springs	161.7 mi · 2h 58m
Lava Hot Springs → Soda Springs	22.1 mi · 27 min
— Soda Springs → Murray, via Logan & Ogden	173.8 mi · 3h 44m
— Soda Springs → Murray, via Bear Lake	194.1 mi · 4h 23m

The Bear Lake option (teal dashed line on the map) trades Preston and the Bear River Massacre site for Garden City's turquoise shoreline and a run down Logan Canyon — about 20 miles and 40 minutes longer, rejoining the original route (blue dashed line) at Logan. Neither total includes the optional gold-pin detours to Bear River Hot Springs or Maple Grove Hot Springs near Preston.

S

Home — Murray, UT

4748 South Glencrest Road, Murray,
UT 84107

Home base — starting and ending point of the loop.

1

Crystal Hot Springs

8215 N Hwy 38, Honeyville, UT 84314

About 13 miles north of Brigham City on the way out, Crystal Hot Springs channels natural mineral water into a range of developed pools from cool to scalding, plus a large recreational pool and waterslide — an easy first soak of the trip, right off I-15. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)

2

Malad City — Oneida Pioneer Museum

27 Bannock St, Malad City, ID 83252

Malad City was settled in the 1860s largely by Welsh immigrants — it's said to have more residents of Welsh descent per capita than anywhere in the U.S. outside Wales. The Oneida Pioneer Museum documents that Welsh, Mormon-pioneer, and Shoshone history, and the 1917 Oneida County Courthouse anchors the small historic downtown a block away. (Idaho Heritage Trust)

3

Devil Creek Reservoir

Devil Creek Reservoir, near I-15 Exit 22, Malad, ID

Tucked into a break in the mountains just north of Malad Pass, Devil Creek Reservoir is stocked with rainbow trout by Idaho Fish & Game. It sits right alongside the highway, with views back down the Malad Valley. (Idaho Fish & Game)

4

McCammon

McCammon, ID 83250

McCammon grew up in 1892 as the junction of the Oregon Short Line Railroad and the Utah & Northern Railway, earning it the old nickname "Junction City." It still carries some of that railroad-town character, including the historic Harkness Hotel, and marks the turnoff from I-15 onto US-30 toward Lava Hot Springs. (Wikipedia)

5

Lava Hot Springs

430 E Main St, Lava Hot Springs, ID 83246

The mineral hot pools here have drawn visitors for well over a century; the Shoshone-Bannock people are said to have treated the springs as neutral, sacred ground where rival tribes could bathe in peace. Today the state-run Hot Pools sit alongside a separate Olympic-size swimming pool and

waterslide complex on the Portneuf River, with Main Street's shops and cafes a short walk away — the turnaround point of the day.

(lavahotsprings.org)

NEARBY DINING

78 Main Street Eatery — Classic American comfort food — burgers, sandwiches, hearty breakfasts — with a true small-town vibe.

Portneuf Grille & Lounge — Northwest-inspired fine dining at Riverside Hot Springs Inn; fresh seafood and aged prime steak.

Riverwalk Thai — Family-owned Thai food in a converted former gas station near the hot springs.

6

Soda Springs Geyser

39 W 1st S, Soda Springs, ID 83276

Drillers looking for a warm-water swimming pool in 1937 accidentally tapped a pressurized aquifer, creating a geyser so powerful the town had to cap it with a valve. It's now set on a timer to erupt roughly on the hour at Geyser Park downtown — an easy stop with picnic tables nearby. (Visit Soda Springs)

NEARBY DINING

Caribou Jack's Trading Co & BBQ — Hardware store with an in-house BBQ cafe — Traeger-smoked meats and home-cooked sides.

Arctic Circle Restaurant — Regional fast-food outpost — a reliable quick stop for burgers and shakes.

Enders Hotel & Restaurant — Historic hotel dining room downtown, known for classic American comfort food.

7

Hooper Springs Park

1805 Government Dam Rd, Soda Springs, ID 83276

Hooper Spring was a documented stop on the Oregon and California Trails, where westbound emigrants paused to sample the naturally carbonated "soda" water the town is named for. A small stone pavilion still covers the spring today, and the shaded park around it makes a pleasant short break — about 2 miles north of the geyser, barely off the direct route. (City of Soda Springs)

8

Bear River Massacre Site

US-91, Preston, ID 83263

On January 29, 1863, California Volunteer troops attacked a Northwestern Shoshone winter camp along the Bear River, killing an estimated 250–400 men, women, and children — more than at Sand Creek or Wounded Knee. A 1932 monument and newer interpretive panels, developed with the Northwestern Band of the Shoshone Nation, mark the bluff overlooking the site, directly on the route into Preston. (Bear River Heritage Area)

9

Preston — Historic Downtown

36 S State St, Preston, ID 83263

Preston's unassuming downtown — including the Franklin County Courthouse, the old Deseret Industries thrift store, and Preston High School — became familiar to millions after Napoleon Dynamite was filmed here on a shoestring budget in 2003. Fans still stop for tater tots and to spot Rex Kwon Do landmarks. (Grahm's Guide)

10

Bear River Hot Springs

3696 N 1600 E, Preston, ID 83263

A low-key, family-owned hot springs resort on the banks of the Bear River, with mineral soaking pools open year-round (hours vary by day). A short detour northeast of downtown Preston, it's a quieter alternative to Lava for a soak on the way home. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)

11

Maple Grove Hot Springs

11386 Oneida Narrows Rd, Thatcher, ID 83283

Tucked into a river canyon along ID-34, Maple Grove is a 45-acre soaking retreat with four to six riverside mineral pools, a beach, hiking trails, and glamping yurts and cabins. It's farther off-route than the other springs — worth it only if there's time for the full detour. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)

12

Logan Tabernacle

50 N Main St, Logan, UT 84321

Built between 1878 and 1891 from local limestone and timber, the Logan Tabernacle has served as a community gathering place for well over a century. It sits at the heart of Logan's walkable downtown in Cache Valley, with the larger Logan Temple visible on the bench above. (Bear River Heritage Area)

NEARBY DINING

Le Nonne Ristorante Italiano — Northern Italian cooking and handmade gnocchi, 129 N 100 East. (City Weekly)

Elements Restaurant — Fine dining at Riverwoods, 35 E 640 South. (City Weekly)

Cafe Sabor — Tex-Mex in a former train depot, 600 W Center St.

13

Box Elder Tabernacle

251 S Main St, Brigham City, UT 84302

The original Box Elder Tabernacle burned in 1896 and was rebuilt within a year; its distinctive candlestick-topped tower and spires make it one of the most photographed buildings in northern Utah. Brigham City is the last stop before this drive rejoins I-15 south toward Murray. (jacobbarlow.com)

14

Ogden — Union Station

2501 Wall Ave, Ogden, UT 84401

Opened in 1924 after fire destroyed its predecessor, Union Station once saw dozens of trains a day pass through Ogden's rail junction connecting the transcontinental line. The restored depot now houses the Utah State Railroad, Browning Firearms, and Browning-Kimball classic-car museums beneath its grand arched windows, with the shops, galleries, and restaurants of historic 25th Street a short walk away — a good last stretch-the-legs stop before the freeway home. (David Jay Fullmer, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons)

NEARBY DINING

Hearth on 25th — Wood-fired, seasonal New American plates, 195 25th St. (City Weekly)

Slackwater Pub & Pizzeria — Craft beer and wood-fired pizza, 1895 Washington Blvd. (City Weekly)

La Crepe OG — Sweet and savory crepes, 2401 Kiesel Ave. (City Weekly)



Return to Murray, UT

4748 South Glencrest Road, Murray, UT 84107

The dashed blue route on the map traces the drive back from Ogden's Union Station down I-15 to Murray — about 42 mi, roughly 45 min.